

Early Societies

These objects reflect the changes that were taking place in human society up to 3000 BCE. The shift from a hunter-gather lifestyle is revealed by the number of farming tools and pottery objects that were made at this time.

[1] **Flint hand-ax** made by *Homo heidelbergensis* in Europe about 500,000–300,000 years ago. [2] **Deer's head carving** from bone, 8000–6000 BCE, from Riparo Gaban, Italy. [3] **Flint axe**, c. 4000–2300 BCE, used to harvest cereal crops. The original flint cutting edge has been fixed in a modern handle. [4] **"Venus" figurine** carved in limestone, c. 25,000–15,000 BCE, from Willendorf, Austria. Figures such as this have been found across Europe; they are always faceless and appear to be heavily pregnant. [5] **Carved rock** from approximately 75,000 years ago, discovered in Blombos cave near Stillbaai, South Africa. Considered to be one of the first examples of art, the piece is made from red ochre with a deliberately engraved design. [6] **Cro-Magnon flute**, c. 45,000 years old, discovered in a cave at Divje Babe, in the Idrija valley in western Slovenia, and thought to be one of the earliest musical instruments. It is made from the femur of a young cave bear. [7] **Flint arrowhead** from around 10,000 years ago. Arrowheads such as this were created by skilled artisans by pressing a bone or antler tool against the edges to create a finely flaked thin artifact. [8] **Bone carvings**, c. 8700 BCE, from Dolní Vestonice, Czechoslovakia. They are believed to be an amulet (left) and a stylized female figure (right). [9] **Carved pillar**, c. 9000 BCE, from the Göbekli Tepe archaeological site in southeastern Turkey. These pillars may be part of an early temple. Other examples show various wild animals and birds. [10] **Stone sculpture**, c. 6000 BCE, showing both fish and human characteristics, from Lepenski Vir, Yugoslavia. Fish were important to the people who lived at this site. [11] **Quernstone**, a simple hand

mill to grind cereal crops. This is a reconstruction of the type used by the first farmers c. 10,000 BCE. [12] **Serrated flint, antler harpoon, and flint point** mounted on a wooden shaft, made by modern humans during and after the late Ice Age, 18,000–10,000 years ago. [13] **Pottery cone** from Jordan, 3rd millennium BCE. [14] **Egyptian dagger**, c. 3500–3100 BCE, from Gebel el-Arak, Egypt, with scenes of battle and hunting carved on the handle, made from hippopotamus ivory, and a blade of the highest quality knapping. [15] **Naqada I bone figure**, 4000–3600 BCE. This is an example of one of the earliest three-dimensional representations of humans from ancient Egypt, found in graves of the predynastic period. [16] **Goddess figurine**, from El' Ma'mariya, Egypt, c. 3600–3500 BCE, made from painted terra-cotta. [17] **Pottery shard**, c. 4000 BCE, from Romania. As well as being useful, pottery was often strikingly painted and engraved as seen in this example. [18] **Carved spearthrower** in the shape of a mammoth, from the rock shelter of Montastruc, Tarn-et-Garonne, France. Approximately 12,500 years old, this tool is carved from reindeer antler. [19] **Foundation stone** engraved with cuneiform writing from the famous Sumerian city of Ur. This 4,000-year-old brick cone was placed in a mud-brick wall to record the foundation of a building. [20] **Egyptian comb** from the predynastic period, c. 3200 BCE. Carved from ivory, the animals include elephants and snakes; wading birds and a giraffe; hyenas and cattle. Parts of the comb's teeth can be seen along the bottom edge. [21] **Uruk pitcher** of limestone with animal carvings from Sumeria, 3500–3200 BCE.

[13] POTTERY CONE



[14] EGYPTIAN DAGGER

[15] NAQUADA I BONE FIGURE

[16] "GODDESS" FIGURINE



[17] POTTERY SHARD

[18] CARVED SPEARTHROWER

[19] FOUNDATION STONE

[20] EGYPTIAN COMB



[21] URUK PITCHER